

Lesson 2: The Power of the T-Shirt Cannon

Jimmy Delaney

Over the course of my time with Tennessee Athletics and with women's athletics and with the Lady Vols, I was very fortunate to go from being a part of the game atmosphere and doing things. Early in my career, I started as the person that dressed up as the mascot and I was the person that shot the t-shirt cannon.

And I remember one game I was in the moment just a little bit too much and I got a little bit too close to the team huddle and I shot some t-shirts. And the next day in the office I was called into, at that point it was Coach Summit's office. And I sat down and she said, "What happened last night?" And I was racking my brain and I couldn't quite remember.

And she said, "I was coaching in the huddle and I was distracted by the t-shirt cannon. And she was like, should I be distracted by that?" And I said, "No, coach, you shouldn't be." And she said, "Look, you go be great at what you're doing and I need to be great at what I'm doing." And she was like, those two things can coexist.

But I just remember in that moment, I was like, this is it. My career is over with. I've just upset Coach Summit. And we were done. She said, "You got it. And I got it." And she said, "Great." She said, "But how far can you shoot a t-shirt?"

And so for me, it was very relieving because where I thought I was about to get grilled and toasted and that was the end of my career, she communicated with me. She made her point. But then after that, she kind of cleared the air and made it very fun. And I did tell her that I can shoot a t-shirt all the way up into the upper deck.